I privately thought that Bernie would not be gone in two months, that Bill would not be that arbitrary, and that Bernie would have to the end of the fiscal year to find another position. I was wrong. Bill fired Bernie on January 7, 1954, with pay to the end of the month. Bernie had been on the job for 2^4 years.

The episode showed me the wisdom of my determined and, finally, successful drive to get out from under Lemon. He could no longer force me to undergo the humiliation of being fired out of hand.

To be sure, I had a similar problem. Dean Faulkner, hearing about all the writing I was doing, was annoyed at my neglecting my research.

How he found out about it and what made him annoyed, I don't know. Lemon both knew and was annoyed and might, conceivably, have told Faulkner of it in order to make trouble for me, but I have no evidence of that.

In any case, Faulkner asked me to come see him, and on December 29, 1953, we had a forty-five-minute talk. I explained the nature of the nonfiction I was doing—showed him my articles in the Journal of Chemical Education—explained my views on the importance of teaching, and won him over. At least there were no more complaints on how I spent my time—from Dean Faulkner, that is.

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I was thirty-four years old on January 2, 1954, and I celebrated my birthday two weeks later by finishing that blasted revision of Biochemistry and Human Metabolism and sending it off on January 15. I-use first-person singular, but that doesn't imply that Walker and Boyd were not involved in the revision. Certainly, however, they were involved to a far smaller extent than I was.

And on January 22, I started on my share of the student-nurse textbook, which we decided to call Chemistry and Human Health.

It was a depressing January. It was the coldest stretch of time since I had arrived in Boston, and I had trouble starting the car in the morning, especially when there was snow—and there was lots of it. The car, as it happened, had to sit in the driveway exposed to the elements because there was no garage attached to the house, and there were times when the engine was simply too cold to start—and at least once I ran down the battery trying.